# The Cost of Not Having Difficult Conversations

The costs of not addressing the underlying issues that would require having difficult conversations are staggering.

**Long-term implications of avoiding these issues:**

- Studies show that chronically unresolved issues play a major factor in at least 50% of the reason why employees leave there job.
- The main reason why employees site leaving there organization is because of "management and leadership's inability to affectively prevent and manage conflicts."
- 70% of workers' compensation claims reported are psychological claims, meaning the claimant's unemployment is listed as being due to unresolved issues that affected the persons ability to fully function at work.

What are the FINANCIAL costs of needing to recruit and train new employees?

What are the FINANCIAL costs of workers' compensation?

What are the OTHER costs of firing and then hiring a new employee? How does it impact other staff members? Put pressure on management? Take time, resources, and focus?

**Short-term consequences (the 4 R's):**

- Resentment: Other employees may become. This can create unnecessary friction and lead to an explosive situation.
- Resistance: Resistance can happen when people dismiss ideas and opportunities because they have negative emotions for those who are presenting them.
- Retaliation: Some people will feel a need to retaliate when situations are not dealt with and they feel like they have been wronged in some way. Retaliation can be obvsious or it can be more subtle, such as lower performance, coming in late, disrespectful behavior and so on.
- Respect: When staff members do not feel that leadership can affectively deal with challenging situations, they lose respect for their leaders. The loss of respect will affect staff's level of cooperation with leadership and their overall commitment to the vision and mission of the company.

**Consider what consequences you and your team will experience if you do NOT address the issue you are facing (now or in the future):**

Will NOT addressing it cause resentment by any other co-worker? How would this impact you? The team? The environment?

Will NOT addressing it deny the employee the opportunity to improve or change behavior? What would be the long-term implications if they don't improve or change?

Will NOT addressing it affect the productivity, motivation, or efficiency of the employee, team, department, or company? Why would this matter?

Will NOT addressing it bring down morale? How could this make things worse?